Team Topology Design

Design teams around the flow of value: team types, how they interact, and how much each team can hold.

Coordinate Teams · Inspired by Team Topologies (Skelton & Pais) · Cognitive Load · Interaction Modes

WORKED EXAMPLE · FICTIONAL TEAM

LEGEND

- Yellow Sticky = A team
- Pink Sticky = Pain point

1 Team Types

MOST TEAMS SHOULD BE STREAM-ALIGNED

Stream-aligned

Owns a flow of work end to end: a product, journey or customer segment. Delivers value directly.

Our teams of this type:

Basket · Search & Browse

Checkout

Platform

Provides internal services that stream-aligned teams use self-service, reducing their load.

Our teams of this type:

Store Platform (cloud, CI/CD)

Enabling

Helps other teams build new skills or adopt practices, for a while, then steps back.

Our teams of this type:

Test Automation coaches (to June)

Complicated subsystem

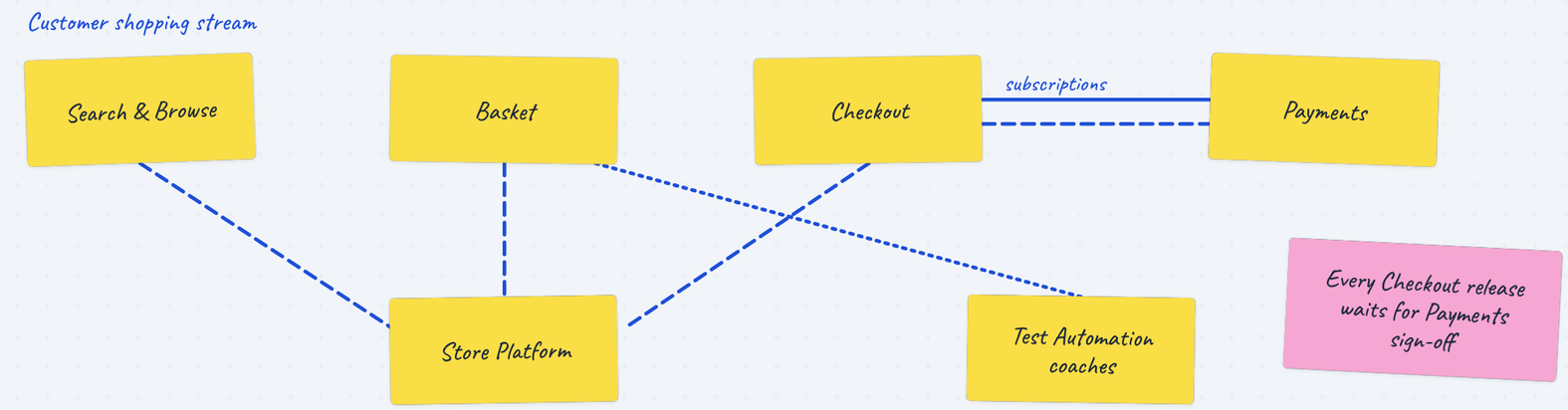
Owns a part needing deep specialist knowledge, so others don't have to.

Our teams of this type:

Payments

2 Team Map

PLACE TEAMS · DRAW HOW THEY INTERACT



3 Cognitive Load Check

CAN EACH TEAM HOLD WHAT IT OWNS?

TEAM	DOMAINS & SYSTEMS OWNED	LOAD L/M/H	TOO MUCH?
Basket	basket, reorder, favourites	M	no
Checkout	checkout, promos, delivery slots	H	yes
Payments	cards, wallets, refunds, fraud	H	watch
Search & Br.	search, catalogue, recs	M	no
Store Platform	cloud, CI/CD, monitoring	M	no

Checkout owns three domains: delivery slots should move.

4 Interaction Agreements

EVERY COLLABORATION HAS AN END DATE

TEAM A	TEAM B	MODE	PURPOSE	REVIEW BY
Checkout	Payments	Collaboration	Build subscription payments	30 June
Checkout	Store Platform	X-as-a-Service	Self-service deploy pipeline	September

5 Changes to Try

- *New Delivery Slots team takes slots from Checkout*
- *Payments publishes a self-service refunds API*
- *Review Checkout–Payments collaboration on 30 June*

"Which team is carrying more than it can hold?"

"If we redrew one team boundary, which dependency would disappear?"

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